MARKET DAY

Written by

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Self-written sample screenplay for Panelwise.
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FADE IN:

EXT. CITY MARKET - DAWN

Stalls go up under striped awnings. Crates of mangoes, pyramids of tomatoes, sacks of mealie meal stacked like sandbags.

AUNTIE PRECIOUS (60s), floral headscarf, reading glasses on a beaded chain, arranges tins of spice in a perfect fan. Every label faces forward.

Across the aisle, a new stall. YUSUF (20s), apron over a football shirt, hangs a hand-painted sign: CHEAPEST SPICE IN TOWN.

Auntie Precious lowers her glasses and reads it.

AUNTIE PRECIOUS
Cheapest. Hm. Cheap is not a flavour.

YUSUF
Good morning to you too, Auntie.

INT. MARKET HALL - DAY

The hall is loud and full. Shoppers push trolleys between the stalls. A pigeon walks along a rafter.

A WOMAN WITH A PRAM stops between the two stalls. She looks left. She looks right.

YUSUF
Peri-peri, sister! Half the price of over there!

AUNTIE PRECIOUS
(not looking up)
And half the taste.

The woman buys from Auntie Precious. Yusuf throws his hands up.

INT. MARKET HALL - LATER

Yusuf sits on an upturned crate eating a samoosa. Auntie Precious weighs out turmeric on a brass SCALE.

A small boy, KAMO (7), tugs at her skirt.

KAMO
Gogo, he has more customers than you.

AUNTIE PRECIOUS
He has more noise than me. That is a different thing.

INT. MARKET HALL - AFTERNOON

A roof gutter overflows. Water pours straight down onto Yusuf's stall. His spice tins float in a spreading yellow puddle.

YUSUF
No! No, no, no!

He grabs at tins with both hands. The CHEAPEST SPICE sign peels off and slides into the water.

Auntie Precious watches over her glasses. Then she stands, picks up an empty crate and marches across the aisle.

AUNTIE PRECIOUS
Stop grabbing. Lift. Crates under, tins on top. Kamo! Newspaper!

Kamo runs with an armful of old newspaper. The three of them build a dry tower of crates.

YUSUF
Why are you helping me?

AUNTIE PRECIOUS
Because if your peri-peri gets wet it will taste even worse.

EXT. CITY MARKET - DUSK

The awnings come down. The puddle shines orange in the last of the sun.

Yusuf repaints his sign on a flattened box. Auntie Precious reads it over his shoulder.

The new sign says: SECOND BEST SPICE IN TOWN.

AUNTIE PRECIOUS
(smiling)
Now that is honest advertising.

YUSUF
Tomorrow I will be first.

AUNTIE PRECIOUS
Tomorrow you will be early. Start there.

She hands him one of her own tins of spice and walks away into the dusk with Kamo.

FADE OUT.